

TP Onsite - High Volume Front-line Recruiters Interview Transcript x2 - 3 Dec 2025

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

So, just in terms of format, we'll do this in a kind of mini round robin. So, you know, I'll start with, start with Pooja, with the question, and then I'll move on to yourself, Checker. But as we go, you know, really, you know, looking to understand, you know, maybe what's similar for you both, but also what's different, where, you know, where are the variances are, you know. deviations and things like that. So, maybe we start with, with Pooja. So, maybe could you tell me a bit about your current role, Pooja? So, you know, what are your main job responsibilities, you know, maybe think about on a, on a typical day, you know, what do you do on a, on a typical day?

Puja Gupta

00:49

So, my... my role is completely from recruiting, so whether it is, you know, from a review, so whatever stages we have under recruiting, review to ready for hire, onboarding, all that is something which I manage for the team. been there with TP for 9 years, so earlier we had a different tool, HRMS, now we have Workday. So, whatever is there from a recruiting perspective. I'm managing that.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

01:19

Makes sense. And I just wanted to confirm, do you typically recruit for, you know, frontline roles, like, high-volume type roles, or what type of roles do you... do you usually recruit for?

Puja Gupta

01:33

So, I am into agent tithing. This is more of a grade A1, B2, that level which we are managing. There is a different team who manages the lateral hiring, and then another team who manages the executive hiring. So, our security roles which are there has been defined in that way, where I will have access only to agents hiring for India.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

02:00

Okay, and it's just, just for India, again, that's very helpful, thank you. And just in terms on, you know, on a regular week, how many, how many agents would you, would you hire on average?

Puja Gupta

02:14

In a week, So, right now, it is the lean period for us. Normally, the numbers would be somewhere around 100.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

02:21

Oh, wow, okay. But then...

Puja Gupta

02:23

When... when there are peak, then we... it goes up to, say, 150?

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

02:30

Okay.

Puja Gupta

02:31

In a week, yeah. So, average, in a month, we hire around 800-2,000 people.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

02:36

Okay, okay. Sorry, how many?

Puja Gupta

02:40

800... 800 to 1,000, yeah, 1,000.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

02:43

Oh, 800 to 1,000, okay, got it. I was like, wow, that's a lot, 8,000, okay, thank you.

Puja Gupta

02:47

When it comes to India, then we can go up to that number also. So India hires around 8,000, 9,000 in a month, so... Okay. But then I was just talking about Kolkata right now, because that's the number which I am focusing on.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

03:00

And it sounds like, you know, is it, is it more seasonal, you know, at the moment? Like, can that number fluctuate depending on different time periods?

Puja Gupta

03:11

Yes, it will. So, there are... there are businesses, mainly the e-commerce business which we have for India. When the hiring is there, then it... it comes for a 3-month period where we hire fixed term, we hire permanent. And those are the time when the numbers are at the peak. So, if you look at, right now, for Amazon, this Black Friday day, which we have. We had some good, thousand numbers to hire back in 2 months, 2 months back. So that is the... that is the way, TP works.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

03:45

Okay, okay, no, that makes sense, and thank you. That just gives us a bit more context as to the type of volumes that you're... that you're working with. So maybe same question to yourself, Shekhar, just in terms of your current role, your main responsibilities. Could you tell us a little bit about that?

Shekhar Monga

04:04

Yeah, so, just to give you an idea, Pooja is part of my team, so we collectively manage frontline hiring. So, I manage frontline hiring for TP North, India North and East. So, Pooja manages east as a region.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

04:21

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

04:22

Collectively, so if I look at my role, what we... so I do frontline hiring, me and my teams, we hire about 1,500 to 2,000 people a week, across multiple regions, across North and East. Okay. So, and these would be about 8 to 9 sites across multiple states in the country, but primarily focusing on north and eastern part of India. Oh. And then, you know, that... again, what you mentioned, seasonal, so this is... when it... when it's a seasonal ramp.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

04:59

It is primarily in.

Shekhar Monga

05:02

sale period? we prepare for the sale period, and some of it is offshore business, and some of it is onshore. So we have India to India campaigns as well, during August, September, October, where October is when we have the Diwali Festival.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

05:18

That's weird.

Shekhar Monga

05:19

The peak season comes in, and we hire, fixed-term hires.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

05:24

You know, for...

Shekhar Monga

05:26

even if I include Amazon as well as other Flipkart e-commerce operations that we hire, and then we also have Instacart. So maybe we hire about 12,000 people in 8 to 10 weeks in that week.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

05:41

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

05:42

North and East, yeah.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

05:44

Yeah, so again, it's very high value, but again, it sounds like...

Shekhar Monga

05:47

Yeah, and that's why the impact of some issue that we face on Workday, you know, it... while... on some days, it may not be creating that huge an impact, because the season is not there, we are hiring regular 1,000, 1,500 people a week. We can still manage that, but when there was a peak, you know, that's when we got really hit bad during our hiring this year. Because of certain limitations that probably we've experienced.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

06:18

And I was gonna ask you, when you say hit bad, like, what do you mean by that?

Shekhar Monga

06:22

Okay, so when we come to objective issues on where our recruitment process used to get stuck, we were never... we were not able to onboard people. We were not able to get their IDs, CCMS IDs, done on Workday. Because of certain limitations. And there were delays in joining, so we had to make the candidates wait till the time our workday issues get fixed, and then we were able to onboard them, which means that we lost business days. being able to start their training, because their NTID creation got delayed. Their workday credentials, they were not... not present, or maybe not working. So, those issues delayed the entire process, and that's where the impact was seen.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

07:09

So because you just went live, so those were fairly recent then, I would imagine.

Shekhar Monga

07:14

Yes.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

07:15

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

07:16

Post-July. So, that's the peak. So it... it got live in July, during the peak. Of hiring, and that's where the newness factor, also had an impact. there are certain issues which are still continuing, while the newness factor is gone now, where we know little workarounds and, you know, we've made people learn Workday. So, things are catching up, but there are certain issues which are still needing help, and that's where... You know, we would take it forward, yeah.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

07:49

And those have been reported and are being worked on, to your knowledge.

Shekhar Monga

07:55

Sorry?

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

07:55

Those, those issues have been reported to how, and they're being worked on to help smooth out later.

Shekhar Monga

08:02

Yeah, yeah. Okay. We've had our, you know. connects... regular connects with our global teams on birthday improvement teams, so there are certain issues that... We're still looking for a solution, yeah.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

08:15

Okay. Yeah, no, again, thank you, thank you for sharing that, and I think definitely interested to, you know, to learn about any current friction points. We'll definitely get to... get to that. Maybe

just a question for you both. In your estimation, what percentage of your time is spent to... is spent in Workday recruiting generally? Would you spend, like, you know, most of your day there, or would it be, just a smaller proportion?

Shekhar Monga

08:47

for a recruiter's life cycle, I think most of the time they spend on Workday.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

08:52

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

08:53

Because... the overall candidate journey starts from Workday application.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

08:59

Yeah.

Shekhar Monga

08:59

And then, other than that, I think it's just a one-on conversation, or a telephonic conversation, or a conversation on Teams or Zoom with the candidate, but that is only for You know, maybe 5 minutes, 10 minutes, and post that. the journey starts on Workday, where the assessments get triggered, and the candidate goes through the assessments, the recruiter gets to see the outcome of those assessments on Workday, and then they eventually move the person from assessments to interview stays, and from interview to offer stays, and all that. So that, most of the time, is workday.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

09:33

Perfect, perfect. So, so yeah, let's, maybe let's walk through those various different stages. I think that will help us understand, you know, where, what, you know, what, maybe what's working well, but what could be improved as well at those various different stages. So, I was curious in terms of for the, you know, these high-volume hires. You know, what are the steps you take to create a job requisition? Is it... is it yourselves that create the... the job rec, or is it, let's say, the hiring manager? And then, like, what are... what are... what part of that process, you know, this early job rec part of the process, you know, causes the friction point that slows things down at the moment?

Shekhar Monga

10:11

Yeah, I'll answer that, and Pooja, pitch in whatever you feel, I may have missed out, or maybe

miscommunicated. So, see, in our legacy systems, the requisition process was over emails. While we did have a tool, we used to create, and recruitment used to create requisitions on that tool.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

10:34

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

10:35

And it was communication with the workforce team, the operations teams over an email, where this is the demand, and this is how, you know, these many people are needed, so we break them into batches, we decide on the dates. So that legacy system is still pretty much the same. However, you know, the tool is different. We do our discussions on requisitions, the demand with the workforce teams, and then It's the recruitment function. We have identified certain people with certain security roles who are creating requisitions for us, basis what dates we agree with the business. So that's when the requisition... that's how the requisition is being created.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

11:18

So, just to clarify, so the... the current, like, communication of the demand is still through email? Okay.

Shekhar Monga

11:28

So, emails and discussions, okay.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

11:32

Okay, but then the actual... so, the approval of those, let's say, you know, 1,000 were approved, whatever, is that then done in Workday? the creationists.

Shekhar Monga

11:44

So, the requisitions gets created. So, once we have an agreed date, and the indent. That's when we go ahead and create the requisitions on Workday. There is no approval process on Workday. Okay, okay. That is being... that is... that is being currently,

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

12:06

Implemented.

Shekhar Monga

12:07

while I know that Workday has an option of, you know, stage-wise approvals for a requisition. But I think today, it's just a requisition which gets created, and we start working on it.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

12:20

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

12:20

The recruitment, the last approval used to be in the process was recruitment approval, and now since we are only creating the requisition, so there's no approval process in place.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

12:31

Okay, okay, you know, that makes sense. And I know it's early days as well, you know, in your journey with Workday Recruiting. You obviously come from a previous system, so I think, you know, that's also interesting for us to understand, like, how did it work before? Maybe what are the differences? Pooja, any additional context you'd add to that in terms of the job requisition creation process? You enmuse?

Shekhar Monga

13:05

Pooja, do you have any other inputs on requisition?

Puja Gupta

13:11

No, nothing. I was just trying to call Prateek also, if he can join, because requisition... and he was supposed to, so... but then he's not responding, because he's the one right now who's creating the requisition for India. Okay. So, if he comes in, good. Otherwise, what Sheikhar mentioned, that is the...

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

13:27

you.

Puja Gupta

13:28

That is actually the process which we are following right now.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

13:33

Okay, and...

Puja Gupta

13:33

So, no other points which I would want to add.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

13:37

Do you use, the evergreen Requisition feature in Workday?

Puja Gupta

13:41

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

13:41

We have evergreen Requisition. For all my sites, so we have an evergreen requisition where We process the candidates first, and then we have business requisitions where we move them once they are through to the joining, yeah.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

13:57

Okay, and just added... oh, sorry, go ahead.

Puja Gupta

14:01

Sorry, so the job requisition which we have, from where we are doing the delivery right now, is not something which we are opening right now at the career site, because the naming which we have done for these job requisitions basically process and client. We are not supposed to declare or disclose the name anywhere, because of which we... the job requisition is not there at the career site. Only evergreen access is given to all the candidates, and DP.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

14:31

Okay. Okay, that makes sense. And just in terms of, again, very high-level estimate, like, what percentage of your time is spent in workday recruiting, creating job recs on a daily basis? Would it be, like, an hour a day? Would it be 2 hours, 30 minutes? Any type of estimate around that?

Puja Gupta

14:57

So, for India, I'll take that, Sheikhar. For India, we get requisition So it's not a projection which comes in very early. We get a real-time projection, and then the team is working on. So on an average, if you talk about every day, yes, the team would have been spending some one or two hours, because it's a different team who is working on it.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

15:21

But then if we actually need to create, because we were using this EIB also earlier to create job requisitions, because we had a mass requisition which was there.

Puja Gupta

15:31

So, sometimes where we can use an EIB, because EIB also takes a lot of time to upload, and if the data is heavy. So, all that was also there, but then on an average, if we consider a day, then it is one and a half hours. Which we normally spend on a requisition. But then this is one and a half hours, this is not... together we are doing it. Maybe, you know, five requisitions came in the morning, and then another five in the afternoon, another five in the evening. That is how we are managing right now.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

15:59

Okay, okay. And just in terms of, you know, any challenges you see at the moment in terms of creating job recs, any friction points, anything that slows you down, or maybe causes you to have to go outside of Workday to complete a, you know, a task within the job rec process?

Puja Gupta

16:20

So, within recruiting, there is none, which... which I feel, but then I will still come back on that point, once I have some inputs from Pratik. But then there is one... one observation which came in from the, from the other team, where we are creating the job requisition. So, for an example, if I'm creating a job requisition for, For, say, process ADC. There is a supervisory org which you need to attach to it. Now, we know the geography of India, it's... it's, the headcount is close to 90,000 to pick one supervisory org, because we... the business does not give us the clarity to which it has to be attached to, because there are multiples. In a month, we are hiring 2,000, so I would need, if I'm creating an indent of 2020 each, then I need multiple people there to be attached. So that is one thing which came from the other side, from the business, that they are... we are randomly picking up right now to create the job requisition, because you cannot create a job requisition because... without that one ID, which has to be put in the system. So that's one observation which came from the business.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

17:27

And it's ongoing... it's an ongoing thing, we don't have a solution yet.

Puja Gupta

17:31

So we are trying to fix something between WFM team, operations team, and within recruiting, so if we get some answer, then we can get a solution out.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

17:41

And so, just to confirm my understanding, what ID is missing that you're.

Puja Gupta

17:45

Supervisory org. So when you create a job requisition, you need to... you need to create that job requisition under a supervisory org that needs a name and a BMS identity. So, since the numbers are higher, what we normally hire in India, it becomes very difficult to pick up 10 people from that process, and it is very difficult to coordinate with operations in WFM to get that one day. So right now, we are randomly picking up people from their account and tagging the job requisition to them, but then that's not actual process, because when you onboard, these people go to the training. After training, it goes to the operations. So that is how the workflow has been defined.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

18:29

Okay, and is that kind of workaround, or that workflow at the moment, is that all done within Workday, or do you need to, you know, create emails, Excel sheets, things like that?

Puja Gupta

18:43

That's something, David, I think we have to pick that, internally only. It's not something which Workday can work on, because that's the standard to create a job requisition for any process. So that's the... that's one observation which came, I thought I'll share it with you. But then from a recruiting, recruiting perspective, we don't have any observation in job requisition right now.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

19:04

Okay, perfect. So there's... I'm sorry, so the soup orgs, there's, either the code of the superg isn't available to create the job rec into, or there's too many soup orgs to select from?

Puja Gupta

19:18

It is available, but then we really don't know, and because the count is high, we really don't know how the input has to come from the other team. So, that's one thing where we are struggling right now, but then it is more of a feedback which has come from operations, not our team. So, I have to connect with Prateek once. If I get through him in next 30 minutes, then I would have more inputs on job requisition.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

19:43

Okay, yeah, I'd be curious to know, like, what's... sort of what's missing in that process. So if you have to create 10 positions or 10 requisitions, we're... we're looking... I think we're

equating requisition to position, just to be... so we're on the same language, so they're the same, speaking the same language. So you select the supervisory org, but then there's information missing in there that doesn't allow you to complete it, and you need to reach out, for a manual.

Shekhar Monga

20:09

No, no, so I'll give you clarity, maybe a typical example. when I'm supposed to create a job requisition, it is for a certain business A. Okay. It's for 20 positions. Those 20 people, when they are supposed to be onboarded, should report to Manager of Business A.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

20:31

Right. So we need the information.

Shekhar Monga

20:34

For, from the business, that which manager will be responsible for this patch? Now, when we try to select that super org, which ideally, you know, we have number of names there. We do not get specific information On which requisition Which supervisor org needs to be selected? And that's why the team randomly selects that process A, Any manager in process A clicks on that, and that gets tagged to that manager. Now, the business comes back stating.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

21:18

I think we lost, we lost Shaker. And we're just given that. Give me a moment. I wonder if it shows the inheritance. Pooja, can you please me? Sorry, Checker, we lost you. Sorry, Checker, we lost you there for about 10 seconds.

Shekhar Monga

21:34

Oh, sorry.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

21:35

Okay, no worries.

Shekhar Monga

21:37

So, while it's not an issue on... it's not a workday issue. It's an issue between the communication from the business and to recruitment, whoever is creating the requisition, that which supervisor needs to be selected for a particular JR. So, it's not a workday issue. But, that's the feedback that we got from our business.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

22:01

Okay. Perfect. Any other perspective from yourself, Shekhar, on the area of job requisitions, or, you know, any other challenges, you know, you see the team facing there? Observations?

Shekhar Monga

22:15

I think we've... we've understood the process, and I think that process is okay. We do not have any observations and requisition. I think we're pretty manageable.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

22:26

Perfect. So yeah, maybe let's move on to, kind of, you know, the next, you know, in terms of things like screening, interview management, how... is that something, first of all, maybe to check, is that something your team, is responsible for in terms of... You know, sending out, any, any assessments, managing, interview schedules, things like that. Is that something you would look after?

Shekhar Monga

22:55

Yes, end-to-end, correct. So, on a requisition, it gets... When a requisition gets posted onto a job site.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

23:04

Or to a hiring agency.

Shekhar Monga

23:07

or to employees, within the organization. My team does that posting.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

23:13

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

23:14

So, we invite applications. basis, whatever channel we want to go with, whether it's a external hiring agency, whether it's a job site, whether it's social media. Whether it's our internal employee, where we are inviting reference, So... Yeah, my team is responsible, starting from that process till the person gets hired, so everything... we are managing that, yes.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

23:43

Okay. You don't have any issues, so you post, positions internally first, and then, maybe to an external career site, so there's no problems there.

Shekhar Monga

23:51

No problem, yes, we do parallel-y as well, whether it's internal, external, we take that call, and we do it, so there are no challenges, per se, in posting the job requisitions.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

24:04

I was curious in terms of the, you know, the... after it's been posted, during the apply flow for candidates, you know, do you hear any friction points during that part of the process for candidates?

Shekhar Monga

24:22

From the candidates, so... Okay, I'll have to give you some background.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

24:30

When... so, in our legacy systems.

Shekhar Monga

24:34

You know, we had, A recruiting bot. Okay? Assessing the candidate, before they even reach the recruiter's desk, okay? Now, we had incorporated that in our legacy systems.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

24:52

We wanted to get that integrated into Workday as well.

Shekhar Monga

24:56

But that integration would have taken a long time, and again, it was something which is, you know. Was... was not quick.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

25:07

Yeah.

Shekhar Monga

25:08

We had made, along with the support of Workday team and IT teams, we've made, a workaround. Where we had our application. Okay, directly not, hitting Workday.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

25:26

Bye.

Shekhar Monga

25:27

The candidate was applying before... even before they could apply to a requisition. There was a landing page which was created, which is kind of a bridge between Workday and our bot. From that landing page, the candidate needs to go through the bot assessment. And post that, they used to come onto the Workday mainstream. Now, from a candidate speaking to a... and answering your question objectively, Workday application, no issues. But, prior to that, the arrangement that we did, initially we had A lot of issues, The landing page, the links for the landing page was not... being received by the candidates on time, there was a lot of delays. Once the links get expired, they were not able to apply and all that jazz. But, objectively, from Workday, no issues. Once the application lands at Workday, no issues.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

26:30

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

26:31

Processing of that application.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

26:33

Yes.

Shekhar Monga

26:34

where... the major issue starts, and before I move to that, Pooja, do you have anything else? Other than this one, application on Workday. Okay. So... The first thing that... As a process needs to happen to an application ends. It needs to go through a duplication check. Whether we have received the same application prior to this or not. Now, that duplication check is... Not as per what we are used to, because our earlier legacy tool He used to tell me. Narokay Shekhar, your application has already been received with TP through an external hiring agency A. And you are... A duplicate candidate. Your application is already there with us, okay? If it is outside the cooling off period, then it would just let in. But otherwise, if it's not in the cooling period, or rather, if it's in the cooling period, then... the application which is already there with TP, we are supposed to process that only. The new application within the cooling off period is not allowed. I think that's where... And Pooja, you would have to chime here. That's where I think we have an issue. One is... We don't have a duplication check. While it throws away the duplication instance. It tells us that, okay, there is an application, but it

doesn't block one, it doesn't lock the source, second. And third, At times, there is not even, And information that it's a duplicate.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

28:24

Hmm, okay.

Shekhar Monga

28:26

So, that's where our major concerns are on duplication check.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

28:33

So it sounds like there's... In your previous system, there was a cooling off period, and if it... if it's... if it was in the cooling off period, then it would... it would flag as duplicate, just so I understand?

Puja Gupta

28:54

Yep. That's right. So it will tell you that you're a... you're an ex-employee, or your application already exists with us.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

29:02

Which Workday is not doing that, actually.

Puja Gupta

29:04

Okay, so for any application which comes in from DEFIL, or from vendor, or a social media, any application, it's a manual activity which a recruiter has to go. So, under that candidate profile, you have that duplicate check option. It's a manual thing which a recruiter has to do. If the recruiter is doing it, good. If not, if it is missed and later we identify that it was a duplicate, we lose out. So that's one of the issues which is... which Workday is right now not giving it to us, and it's more of a manual thing which a recruiter has to do it. So we have created... created some hygiene check for recruiters, and this is on our paper. So, for a recruiter to miss that activity, if you... if you talk about the RICS, it is very high, because we cannot expect all our recruiters doing that activity. So, it's a checkpoint which we have given, but then it is not being followed, or we are not expecting them to follow thoroughly, because manually it is not possible.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

30:04

Yeah, at the volumes you're working at, yeah, I can only imagine. just, again, rough estimate, Pooja, like, how much time would that take every day for recruiters if, you know, even if they're

doing some of the manual checking, how much time would that take?

Puja Gupta

30:23

So, this duplicate check is linked with another check, David, which I want to highlight. We had picked that up with Gail, who is our recruiting expert. workday. Now, when a vendor is uploading a, uploading a lead in the system, recruiter has to go to MyTax. go to that, upload which has happened. Within that upload, I have... I have a small box to check whether there was any duplicate in the system or not. If I do that check, good. If I don't do that check, if I miss it... miss out, then I... then I have missed out. Now, for a recruiter. I have to go to all the profiles which has been uploaded by the vendor and approve it. We spoke to Gale about it, we had picked up that, you know, you remove this approval thing from the system, where, there is... so, my recruit... because a vendor is actually uploading 100 profiles in a day. And for a recruiter, I need to put one person in the system who will only approve the vendor's upload, which is there. Other than that, the person would not be able to do anything else. So that was one of the challenges which was happening, but then we could not remove that approval for vendors. The reason was that if we remove it, then it will also not allow any rehire candidates to come in the system. It had a clause, I will just try and find that.

Shekhar Monga

31:49

So, David and Robert, the issue and the quantum is very big, because I'll tell you, we have about 300, 400 recruiting agencies. Who worked for us.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

32:03

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

32:03

Each agency, on an average, would definitely upload about 10 to 20 Profiles in a single day.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

32:11

Yeah.

Shekhar Monga

32:12

Which makes it... You know... about... 2,000, 3,000, maybe more profiles during the day where one recruiter, the entire bandwidth is that the person would only sit on workday. Click on each profile. find out whether it's duplicate or not, and it takes almost the entire day. So I have one resource at every site who's only doing this. And it's a no-brainer activity if it... it would... it can be automated in the system. Otherwise, it's all manual hours going into completely unproductive work.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

32:48

Yeah. So, if I could just repeat this, because I think I've heard this before, so if you do a bulk upload, and you don't check that box to check for the duplicates, it's too late. You have to go into each one manually and check it.

Shekhar Monga

33:00

Even if it's a single upload, every single upload, also, a recruiter has to manually go check a duplicate. And then approve it for it to be getting into the screening, or review and screening zone.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

33:16

Yeah. Okay.

Shekhar Monga

33:17

Yeah.

Puja Gupta

33:18

Yeah. I've given the description also, David, in the chat. I had no... I had copied-pasted this with me to keep a reference, that, like, we could not remove the approval for vendor uploads. The reason was, if we remove the vendor approval. Then, it will not allow any worker, any ex-worker or a pre-hire to apply in the system again. And if we want to get that application, then we have to delete the data, which our compliance does not allow. We cannot delete any employee data from the system. Now, that is... That is the two things which are clashing, because of which now also my recruiter has to go and approve each lead so that it comes to the system. Now, this is linked with... this is linked with another issue, that is ownership of the source which is there. So, for an example, Shaker has uploaded that lead, from vendor. And I have not approved it, but then I got this candidate from a different source. Now, when I'm getting this candidate from a different source, Workday is not going to capture the first source which was there, which was Shaker, but then it will capture the second source. processes?

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

34:32

Yeah, so now also we are facing this problem, because Workday is capturing the second source, which is coming to the system.

Puja Gupta

34:39

So, it allows... it allows the duplicates to come into the picture, that is one thing, which is a

bigger issue. And then, the other issue is that I... if it is in that cooling period of 30 days, 90 days, which... whatever has been defined in the system, the first source should be captured. So for an example, employee referral uploaded on 3rd December. When a vendor uploaded on 4th December. Workday is capturing the source which is being uploaded last, which is vendors. But then it still comes under the cooling period. Ideally, my source should be 3rd December, the referral which was uploaded. So that is... that is also a bigger... so we... we were... we had this point, the source, ownership, for profiles, but then I... I just thought that I will be able to explain you from here only, because that is becoming a challenge for us when we have to go and approve all the links.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

35:33

So you're losing out on candidates, then, because they need to wait longer, because it's not recognizing the earlier, source.

Shekhar Monga

35:39

So, no, it's not about losing candidates, David, only. The issue is much bigger, and it has financial implications. For example. if I'm... I have a recruiting agency A who is uploading that profile today on 3rd of December, and then there is a recruiting agency.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

35:59

who's uploaded a profile on 4th of December.

Shekhar Monga

36:02

Now, the fourth, Agency B, calls up Pooja and tells Puja, Pooja, I have a candidate I've already uploaded, can you please approve that? Now, Pooja goes ahead and approves B? Agency B candidate. Now, Agency A is still waiting for the candidate to be approved by a certain recruiter.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

36:21

Hmm.

Shekhar Monga

36:22

But in the meanwhile, since Pooja has approved you know, the agency B, The workday will identify that candidate to be referred by Agency B.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

36:34

Agency A will not get paid. Now, if that candidate gets hired, agency A who actually uploaded

the profile first will not get.

Shekhar Monga

36:43

paid.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

36:45

Yeah.

Shekhar Monga

36:45

As per our contract.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

36:47

Yes.

Shekhar Monga

36:48

We have a huge pile on such cases today. where this has been missed, and we don't know how we're gonna correct those sources on Workday. I'm sitting on the pile of cases myself, and I'm trying to find out a solution. How we get that correction done, so that the correct agency gets paid for their references.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

37:11

Yeah, it makes sense, yeah, because ultimately, agency fees, and then being credited for that referral depend on that source tracking, right? So, no, it makes, it makes total sense that, you know, that's a... that's a big friction point. Maybe just to switch gears a little bit, just wanted to kind of cover the last part of the process. In terms of, you know, interview management and then into offers, it sounds like, again, that's something your team would be responsible for in that kind of end-to-end process. Could you tell me a bit about your kind of day-to-day experiences with, you know, with that part to the flow, particularly at the, you know, the high volumes, like things like interview scheduling, things like sending out offer letters, maybe in high volumes. Could you tell me a bit about that? Maybe, Pooja, maybe if you want to go first.

Puja Gupta

38:11

Oh... Of a letter experience, especially for the cases where we have to, you know, so... In our earlier system, there were cases... I'll pick examples only to explain. Now, I onboarded a candidate with a wrong compensation. But then this candidate had accepted the offer letter, because we hire in bulk.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

38:33

So this candidate came into the system.

Puja Gupta

38:37

Now, Workday is giving me an option to release the letter, which is there, so regenerate offer letter option is there, but then this regenerate offer letter, I cannot use it for compensation change.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

38:50

Okay.

Puja Gupta

38:51

because of which, I am not being able to give a letter. The letter which the employee should get, I'm not being able to give that letter to them.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

38:57

opposite.

Puja Gupta

38:58

So right now, we don't have a solution to it. So, we got this regenerate offer letter just for the cases, because when we started Workday, there were a lot of cases which were missed. So, because Workday gives you an option. If you don't accept your offer letter, we can still move you to ready for hire. So that option was there earlier, which, where we have put in some security, now we have put in some clauses, that if offer letter is blank, the letter would... should not be... the... the step of ready for hire, all that should not reflect, which is happening right now.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

39:28

But for the cases which we onboarded between July, July, August, because that is the time when we had a lot of issues with compensation.

Puja Gupta

39:36

James Hunter was working on it, he was the SME for compensation, where, there were, compensation released with the wrong calculation. There were no PAF gratitude, which is mandatory for India, but then the letters were released, and the agent who was being hired at

that kind of package did not even see that, you know, these are the misses. Neither we could identify it, because The earlier system was completely, you know, aligned to our requirement, and we thought that, you know, it is going to work fine. But then later, we got some 400-500 people who came back with a wrong compensation, which was issued to them. They have... they had accepted the offer letter, but right now, Workday is not giving me that option to regenerate the offer letter with the correct compensation. So, regenerate offer letter is there, and I can use it only for the candidates who missed that step. It is not, it is actually not for me to give a revised letter with the compensation which should be there. So that is one challenge, and it's a... It's a high-level issue also, because we've been getting a lot of escalations on this, and we don't have a solution right now, because if I am offering a letter to someone, I have to put it in the system. Now, Workday is not even giving me that opportunity that even if I'm offering that letter outside Workday, and I store it within Workday, that option is also not there. Ideally, all my documents which goes to the employee should be in one system, but then that is not there right now. So that regenerate offer letter is a problem label. Shaker, if you want to add anything.

Shekhar Monga

41:11

Yeah, and it's not only about compensation change. Rather, any change in the offer letter, you're not able to update that on birthday and resend it to the employees or the candidates. So if I'm a candidate and I've got... I've asked for a date of... change of date, you know, on the joining. And I'm saying that I will not join on 2nd now. I request if it can be changed to 8th. Now, if we make that change, Workday doesn't allow us to make that change on the offer letter, And there's no option to resend that offer letter, even if it changed the date.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

41:49

And, I suppose, at what stage would the date that, you know, that example that, you know, the date need to be changed? Would that be during ready-for-hire, or... yeah, where would that typically have to change?

Shekhar Monga

42:01

Yeah, so, for example, yeah, so at the ready for hire stage, so let's say I've already pushed the candidate to a ready-for-hire stage. After that, there is a change in date or compensation.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

42:14

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

42:15

So, I heard at the time of first instance, when we were getting trained on Workday, there was an option of rescind offer.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

42:24

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

42:24

I don't think that access is available to us at the moment.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

42:29

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

42:31

I may be wrong, but I have not seen that coming as a solution to me, that we can rescind any offer and resend an offer. That option is not given to us at the moment.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

42:41

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

42:42

Yep.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

42:42

Yeah, that... yeah, I think that would be words. definitely worth following up on, in terms of... because I think that's... that sounds like the type of use case where rescind would be helpful. Just curious, like, it sounds like it's obviously, you know, it's a major friction point at the moment. Are you using any workarounds at the moment? Are the offers kind of,

Shekhar Monga

43:07

We're still grappling and, you know, trying to find a workaround, because...

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

43:12

Because of a lot of compliance issues, now if I... and the only workaround is that I start giving manual letters to people.

Shekhar Monga

43:19

Yeah. You know, I start emailing them separately, I create a separate letter. Which looks like an

offer letter from a... from a TP standpoint, because it's... it's actually a document which... it's a legal document. Anybody can question us on the legality of that document. So our legal teams and, you know, risk teams, they all have to approve that document before I can even send it from my mailbox. Or we take a printout, create document, and have a printout being sent by mail to the... to the candidates. Now, those are still in consideration, but we've still not gotten a solution to it.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

43:55

Yeah, you know, that's... yeah, that sounds like quite a manual process for, you know, for that many offer letters, which, you know, ultimately we want to avoid you having to do. Yeah, maybe one other question, just around offers. Do you use mass offers? Like, do you use any mass actions around writing offer letters at the moment?

Shekhar Monga

44:15

No. Oh, okay. Individual.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

44:18

Individually. Okay. And just roughly, how many offer letters would you send out every, every day?

Shekhar Monga

44:27

Oh... Quite a few, actually. So... If I only talk about my span, Not... 20 per site, So about 100 to 150 offers a day.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

44:48

Oh yeah, okay, okay, so yeah, I think that makes sense, and in terms of, you know, those friction points obviously multiply if you're sending out, you know, that many.

Shekhar Monga

44:57

See, we don't have to resend an offer on every case.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:01

Yes.

Shekhar Monga

45:01

It could be, you know, only the changes, and at times, even we initiate that change, because

business comes back to us and tell us, oh, sorry, 5th of December, we can't take the batch. We have to move the batch to 7th of December, or 10th of December. So, when we initiate that change, as in TP initiates that change, still we are not able to, you know, redo the offer letter for all the 20 people that were supposed to join the batch on 5th of December.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:27

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

45:28

So, yeah, that's... that's an issue.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:30

And does the candidate sometimes maybe, make changes as well? They're like, I can't start now, but maybe can you, let me start maybe a week later, in which case you'd have to regenerate it?

Shekhar Monga

45:39

Yeah, we can't... we're not able to do that, yeah.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:42

Right, but that's another... so the candidate also can initiate a date to the.

Shekhar Monga

45:46

Guys?

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:46

for example.

Shekhar Monga

45:47

Alright? Correct.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

45:48

Okay, thank you. Just a couple more questions from my side, just again, relating to offers. Do you use eSign? You know, Adobe Sign, DocuSign for offer letters, or is it kind of more of an acknowledgement from candidates?

Shekhar Monga

46:04

It's an acknowledgement over the candidate home. The... the interface which gets created at the time of application. That's when... that's where they can see their offer. They click on it, and they acknowledge that.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

46:20

Okay. And then after that, do they need to sign anything else, or is that... is that acknowledgement...

Shekhar Monga

46:27

No, that acknowledgement is... Is... is what it is.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

46:30

Perfect, okay. No, that makes sense. Maybe just, I suppose, more... just open-ended question in terms of the entire, you know, end-to-end flow that you, you know, you look after. If you can automate or eliminate one task in that end-to-end flow, what would save you the most time and significantly improve the, you know, the experience you have on a day-to-day basis? So it could be something we've discussed already, or, you know, maybe a different Like, you know, anything in interview management, for example. Is there one major friction point that, you know, if we helped automate it, that it would save a lot of time?

Shekhar Monga

47:16

Duplication. I would say duplication needs to get automated, and it needs to be... The checks... the validation needs to be on more parameters than just first name, phone numbers, and email address. Maybe social security number, just like we have Aadhar in India. So, the duplication needs to... because at most of the times, in quite a few cases, candidates come in with different phone numbers, different email addresses, we are not able to check that duplication. But if that duplication check is done on their ADHAR number, we'll be able to identify that.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

47:57

Okay, no, that's interesting, yeah, because I think with, I know if... I presume TP are probably using our duplicate management framework. There, you know, there's configurability in there in terms of different parameters for, for matching, so it might be interesting in terms of, yeah, is there any opportunity there to also include government ID, which is the adhard number, I think you mentioned there, was it?

Shekhar Monga

48:27

Yeah, so that ID, while we are accepting the government ID at the application stage. But for some reason, it is not being used as a validation in duplication.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

48:40

Okay, okay. And are there any other IDs you have to connect... you have to collect from the candidate during the, during the flow, besides the ATAR number?

Shekhar Monga

48:50

Yeah, so, mandatory ones are ADHAR and UAN. It's, it's a universal account number. Again, that is related to the statutory compliances that the government of India has. So these are the two card... the two numbers that are managed. Yeah, and panel.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

49:12

Which is permanent account number. PAN number is, again.

Shekhar Monga

49:15

Related to their salaries and, you know, taxation.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

49:20

Okay, and are these collected at... just... sorry, very final question. Are those three numbers collected as mandatory data points during the apply flow from the candidate, or where would they be collected at the moment?

Shekhar Monga

49:33

It's at the application... during the application stage only. So, Adhar is at the application stage.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

49:41

Yeah.

Shekhar Monga

49:42

And the rest are at the offer stage.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

49:44

Okay.

Shekhar Monga

49:45

So they're mandatory at the offer stage.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

49:47

And are they... okay, cool, and they're all configured as mandatory, like, you don't have to go chasing up for missing numbers or anything like that?

Shekhar Monga

49:57

No, there's no manual intervention, so it's kind of a mandated document, while the recruiters continue to, you know, chase candidates so that the offers get closed on time.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

50:08

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

50:08

So they continue to chase them to update their IDs and, you know, documents and all that, so that we are able to create offers on time and make them join on time.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

50:16

Okay, well, that makes sense. And might just check with Robert, do you have any final questions? I don't, but this was actually very enlightening for me. Yeah, I can see a lot of things here, for sure. Yeah. Yeah, no, again, I really appreciate both of your time. Just, if there are, if there are any other, pieces of feedback that come to mind, or I know, Pula, you mentioned your, you know, your colleague might have more information around the job requisition stage. Feel free to, you know, drop them in an email to myself. My email is on the invite, myself and Roberts. Just if, yeah, if there's any other details you'd like to share that we didn't cover, feel free to, you know, to follow up. via email. And, one thing I just did want to say is that this was actually very, kind of refreshing to hear that, yeah, you had little bumps coming out of July, but you seem to get on top of them quite quickly, and you sort of understand, you know, right now, how things work. It's not... while it's not perfect. You're very creative, like, with your workarounds, then still working with the global team here, right, to make sure everything does stay in Workday, and that you can maximize Workday as much as you can, so it's really nice to hear you guys, are creative in that sense, because you certainly have a high volume to deal with here. We'll take, like I mentioned at the beginning, we'll take Your feedback, anonymized, of course. and bring this back to our teams in terms of, you know, any recommendations we can provide, both in terms of, like, configuration to help relieve some of

those issues, but also, you know, consideration for priority, you know, priority on our roadmap as well. Because, you know, we understand, particularly working at that type of volume, that, you know, having to do some of these manual processes do take up a lot of time, and, you know, I'm sure, you know. There's automation opportunities there, so that's something I'm definitely looking out for.

Shekhar Monga

52:09

One last bit that I want to add, The overall flow of application in Workday, as per the design, it has really eased out. a lot of manual work that we used to do. It has really brought everything into one system, the reporting, the analytics, and everything that has really helped me as a manager to know what is happening at all my sites. It's very easy today, what all requisitions, where are they placed. how are we faring in terms of the fill rate and everything? Otherwise, it's an easy peasy thing today. So, all in all, the design is excellent. These small teething issues, while they appear small, but because of the scale at which we work. They've become really big, and... And, the other aspect is, I think, The training of our team members on Workday has been a task. Because they were actually training... we were training them on the job. You know, we didn't have, no hiring week or a no hiring month, so that we could have trained them before. So they actually got trained while everything was running the same way.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

53:20

Right.

Shekhar Monga

53:20

So that's... that's why I said, maybe there were workarounds we were not aware, but I think today we know a lot about Workday, how we're gonna work around that. The only aspect which is also getting us hit, and that could be one of the feedback items that you should take back, is.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

53:36

Yep.

Shekhar Monga

53:37

Lot of downtimes are planned on a Saturday for Book Day.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

53:41

We've heard that as well, yeah, on Earth.

Shekhar Monga

53:43

Now, India, we work... we don't have Saturday as an off day, okay? So... and... it is also impacting our business a lot. Yep. And that's something that the global team and everybody should look at. India is a big business country. We have huge revenues. And even, you know, 10-minute loss on productivity is quite a thousand euros. So, if it's the Saturday 6-hour window not available for us.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

54:17

It becomes really, really impacting. Yeah, we've heard that, yes, so we're... it's being worked on, let's just say. Yeah, absolutely, yeah, our goal there is to get zero downtime and, you know, totally appreciate, especially in, you know, let's say non-US markets, and, you know, it's amplified again, you know, with different time zones or different working days as well, so... Yeah, that's definitely feedback, you know, we've heard, and something that.

David Denham

54:42

But, you know, we're definitely bringing back nurses.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

54:44

well.

David Denham

54:45

Listen, I just want to be respectful of your time. Apologies, I know we ran 5 minutes over, but, definitely learned a lot. Thank you so much for all your...

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

54:53

from Karen.

David Denham

54:54

experience with us.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

54:56

And, like I said.

David Denham

54:57

I mean.

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

54:58

You'll put this together.

David Denham

54:59

Part of our feedback, and, and...

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

55:03

Thank you.

David Denham

55:03

You good?

David Denham - Sr. Product Manager

55:04

Alright, thank you very much.

Shekhar Monga

55:06

Thank you, Robert. Thank you, David. Thanks, Pooja.

Puja Gupta

Bye.